# SWRT for nonlinear four-wave interactions in ecWAM: installation and quick guide

SWRT (sparse Webb–Resio–Tracy) computes the nonlinear four-wave interactions $S_{nl}$ from K configurations of the WRT quadrature table, each a quadruplet and its mirror image, with one optimized coefficient per configuration. This patch adds SWRT to ecWAM as an alternative to the Discrete Interaction Approximation (DIA) in `SNONLIN`. In a 24-h global test, SWRT keeps the significant wave height within 1 % of WRT, compared with 15 % for DIA, and takes 1.6 times the time per step of DIA.

The changes, the SWRT files and this guide are on the branch `swrt` of Jialunx/ecwam, a fork of ecmwf-ifs/ecwam at commit `e1779dc0` (ecWAM 1.5.14).

## 1. Changes to ecWAM

The patch adds one source file and changes eight others. The default `INLSCHEME = 0` leaves ecWAM unchanged.

| File | Change |
|---|---|
| `src/ecwam/snonlin_swrt.F90` (new) | `INISNONLIN_SWRT` reads the SWRT file and checks it against the spectral grid. `SNONLIN_SWRT` takes the arguments of `SNONLIN` and adds $S_{nl}$ to `SL` and its diagonal term to `FLD`. |
| `src/ecwam/yowstat.F90` | Declares the switch `INLSCHEME`. |
| `src/ecwam/mpuserin.F90` | Reads `INLSCHEME` in namelist `NALINE`, 0 for DIA (default) and 1 for SWRT. |
| `src/ecwam/userin.F90` | Writes the scheme to `wam.log` and stops for other values. |
| `src/ecwam/initmdl.F90` | Calls `INISNONLIN_SWRT` when `INLSCHEME = 1`. |
| `src/ecwam/implsch.F90` | Calls `SNONLIN_SWRT` instead of `SNONLIN` in the source-term integration when `INLSCHEME = 1`. |
| `src/ecwam/wdfluxes.F90` | Calls `SNONLIN_SWRT` instead of `SNONLIN` for the wave-dependent fluxes at the initial time when `INLSCHEME = 1`. |
| `src/ecwam/CMakeLists.txt` | Adds the new file to the build. |
| `share/ecwam/scripts/ecwam_run_model.sh` | Passes `isnonlin`, `inlscheme` and `swrt_operator` of the yml settings to the namelist and the environment. |

`SNONLIN_SWRT` computes in single precision, with the grid points of an NPROMA block as the innermost loop, and flushes subnormal numbers to zero inside this routine only. The SWRT files hold the deep-water interactions, which `ISNONLIN` scales in shallow water as it scales DIA.

As in `SNONLIN`, the diagonal term is the derivative of $S_{nl}$ at a spectral bin with respect to the spectral density at that bin. Each quadruplet of SWRT moves action from $k_3$ to $k_1$, its two wavenumbers on the spectral grid, at a rate proportional to $T = n_1\, n_3\, (n_4 - n_2) + n_2\, n_4\, (n_3 - n_1)$, where $n_i$ is the action density at $k_i$ and $n_2$ and $n_4$ are interpolated. The diagonal term of the quadruplet is proportional to $\partial T/\partial n_1 = n_3\, (n_4 - n_2) - n_2\, n_4$ at $k_1$ and to $-\partial T/\partial n_3 = -n_1\, (n_4 - n_2) - n_2\, n_4$ at $k_3$, as in the WRT code Xnl (van Vledder 2006).

## 2. Installation

The branch can be cloned directly.

```
git clone -b swrt https://github.com/Jialunx/ecwam
```

An existing clone of ecWAM at commit `e1779dc0` takes the same changes from the patch.

```
git checkout e1779dc0aec1210ab6f5339a2582fbb7b6b18e6b
curl -LO https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Jialunx/ecwam/swrt/swrt/ecwam_swrt_e1779dc0.patch
git apply ecwam_swrt_e1779dc0.patch
```

ecWAM then builds as before and needs no new library. The SWRT files are in the folder `swrt/files` of the branch and go to any directory the model can read. The files for the other spectral grids of section 3 are in the same folder.

```
curl -LO https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Jialunx/ecwam/swrt/swrt/files/swrt_ec4x_K31L13.ww3op
curl -LO https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Jialunx/ecwam/swrt/swrt/files/wrt_table_K807.ww3op
```

| SWRT file | Method | Configurations | Offsets | Use |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `swrt_ec4x_K31L13.ww3op` | SWRT | 31 | 13 | runs with SWRT, selected for four times the $S_{nl}$ cost of DIA |
| `wrt_table_K807.ww3op` | WRT | 807 | 74 | reference runs, all configurations with coefficient 1 |

## 3. Spectral grid

The SWRT files depend on the spectral grid only, not on the spatial grid or the time step. The spectral grid of ecWAM is set by the number of directions, the number NFRE of frequencies, and the reference frequency fr1 of bin ifre1, and its frequency ratio is fixed at 1.1. NFRE is the number of frequencies of the source terms, whereas `frequencies` in the yml file sets the number of propagated frequencies. The branch holds SWRT files for the common spectral grids below, each selected as the operational file is, for about four times the $S_{nl}$ cost of DIA.

| SWRT file | Directions × NFRE | First frequency (Hz) | Ratio |
|---|---|---|---|
| `swrt_ec4x_K31L13.ww3op` | 36 × 36 | 0.0345 | 1.1 |
| `swrt_d24_f0345_K27L16.ww3op` | 24 × 36 | 0.0345 | 1.1 |
| `swrt_d24_n30_f0345_K29L14.ww3op` | 24 × 30 | 0.0345 | 1.1 |
| `swrt_d24_n40_f0345_K27L16.ww3op` | 24 × 40 | 0.0345 | 1.1 |
| `swrt_d12_f0418_K29L14.ww3op` | 12 × 36 | 0.0418 | 1.1 |
| `swrt_d24_f0418_K27L16.ww3op` | 24 × 36 | 0.0418 | 1.1 |
| `swrt_d36_f055_K29L14.ww3op` | 36 × 36 | 0.055 | 1.1 |

The first frequencies 0.0345, 0.0418 and 0.055 Hz correspond to fr1 = 4.177248E-02 Hz at ifre1 = 3, the same fr1 at ifre1 = 1, and fr1 = 0.055 Hz at ifre1 = 1. A run names the file of its spectral grid in `swrt_operator` (section 4), and the model stops with a message when the file and the grid differ. The files with 30 and 40 frequencies also need NFRE = 30 or 40 in namelist NALINE, which the standalone scripts set to 36. The scripts in `tools/` of the SWRT code archive (doi:10.5281/zenodo.23654016) build a file for any other spectral grid in about an hour.

## 4. Running

| Setting | Where | Value |
|---|---|---|
| `INLSCHEME` | namelist `NALINE` | 1 for SWRT, 0 for DIA (default) |
| `WAM_SWRT_OPERATOR` | environment | path of the SWRT file |
| `ISNONLIN` | namelist `NALINE` | shallow-water scaling 0, 1 or 2, as for DIA |
| `WAM_SWRT_DIAG` | environment | `0` switches the diagonal term off (optional) |

The standalone scripts read the same settings from three lines of the yml file.

```
physics:
    inlscheme: 1
    isnonlin: 0
    swrt_operator: /abs/path/swrt_ec4x_K31L13.ww3op
```

The log file `wam.log` names the scheme, the SWRT file, and its numbers of configurations and offsets. The model stops with a message when the variable is unset or the file is missing.

## 5. Test results

### 5.1 Synthetic and ERA5 spectra

The error ε of the direction-integrated $S_{nl}$ (van Vledder 2006, Eq. 58) is computed against WRT on 300 synthetic spectra that were not used in the selection, half of them single-peaked and half bimodal. SWRT follows WRT closely, whereas the

error of DIA exceeds the magnitude of $S_{nl}$ itself.

| Method | Median ε (%) | 95th percentile of ε (%) |
|---|---|---|
| SWRT with K = 31 | 8 | 18 |
| DIA of ecWAM | 125 | 190 |

ERA5 spectra on their own grid of 24 directions and 30 frequencies give a similar result. Over 1171 deep-water ERA5 spectra on a 5° grid at 00 UTC 1 January 2019, the median ε is 8 % for SWRT with the ERA5 file of section 3 (K = 29) and 72 % for DIA. In a single-peaked and a bimodal example, with ε of 8 and 10 % for SWRT and 58 and 61 % for DIA, SWRT reproduces the transfer of WRT in frequency and direction, whereas DIA overestimates its largest values by a factor of 1.6 and 2 and adds transfer at directions where WRT has none (Fig. 1).

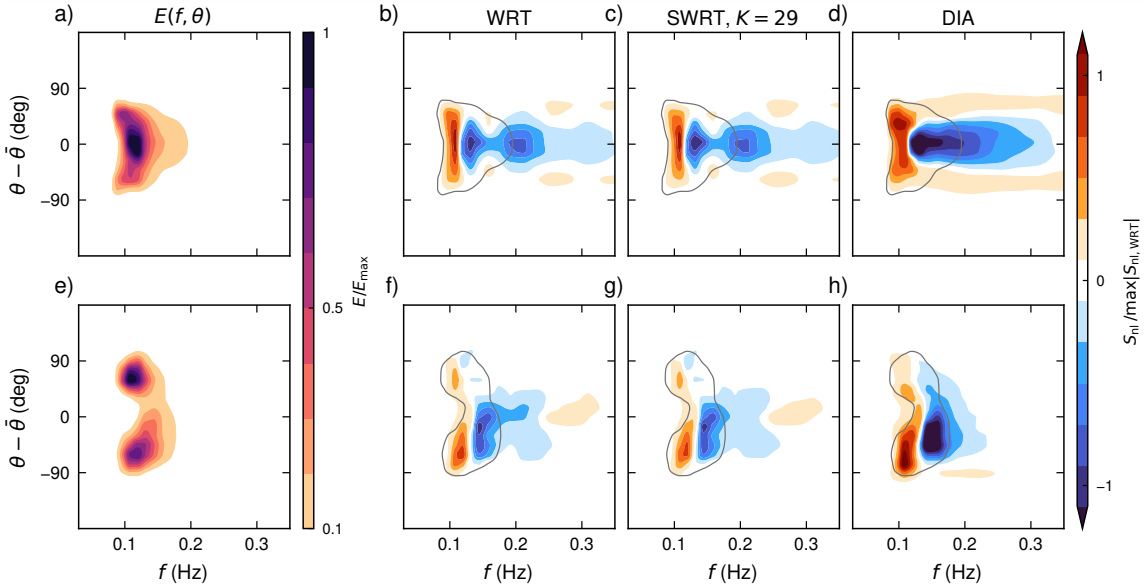



**Fig. 1.** Two ERA5 spectra at 00 UTC 1 January 2019, (a)–(d) a single-peaked wind sea at 20° N, 120° E and (e)–(h) a bimodal sea at 10° S, 160° E. (a, e) E(f, θ) / $E_{max}$; (b–d, f–h) $S_{nl}$(f, θ) from WRT, SWRT with K = 29 and DIA, divided by the largest $|S_{nl}|$ of WRT, with the contour E = $E_{max}$ / 10 in grey. Directions are relative to the mean direction θ̄.

## 5.2 Global test

The global test extends the regression case `etopo1_oper_an_fc_048` of ecWAM to 24 h on the 36 × 29 spectral grid, from 12 UTC 31 December 2022 to 12 UTC 1 January 2023. It starts from rest with the ECMWF operational 10-m winds and sea ice, the physics of iphys = 1 and time steps of 900 s. The errors $\varepsilon_{Hs}$ and $\varepsilon_{Tz}$ are the relative differences from the run with WRT, summed over the hourly outputs from t = 1 h and over the sea points where $H_s$ of WRT is at least 0.1 m.

| Method | $\varepsilon_{Hs}$ (%) | $\varepsilon_{Tz}$ (%) | Mean $H_s$ at 24 h (m) |
|---|---|---|---|
| WRT | – | – | 1.20 |
| SWRT with K = 31 | 0.7 | 0.8 | 1.19 |
| DIA | 15 | 9 | 1.35 |

SWRT keeps the significant wave height within 1 % of WRT at every hour and nearly everywhere, while DIA gives 15 % higher values (Figs. 2 and 3).

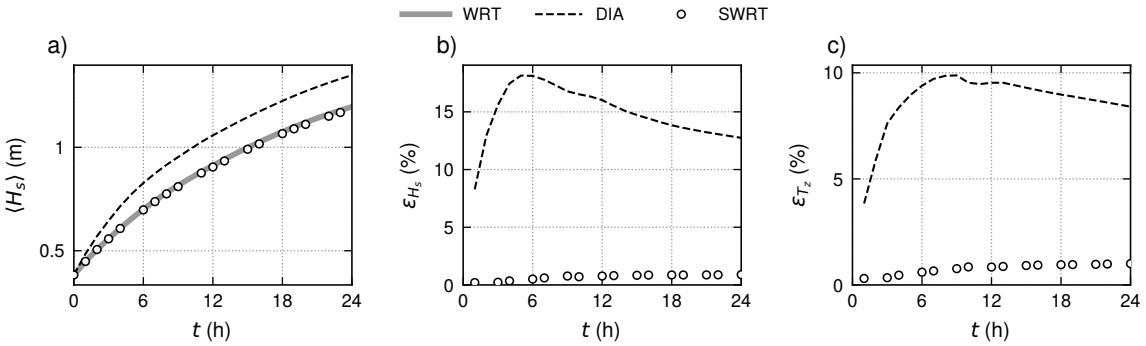



**Fig. 2.** Global statistics of the 24-h ecWAM test with $S_{nl}$ from WRT (thick gray line), DIA (dashed) and SWRT with K = 31 (circles). (a) Mean $H_s$ over the sea points; (b) $\varepsilon_{Hs}$ and (c) $\varepsilon_{Tz}$ at each hour.

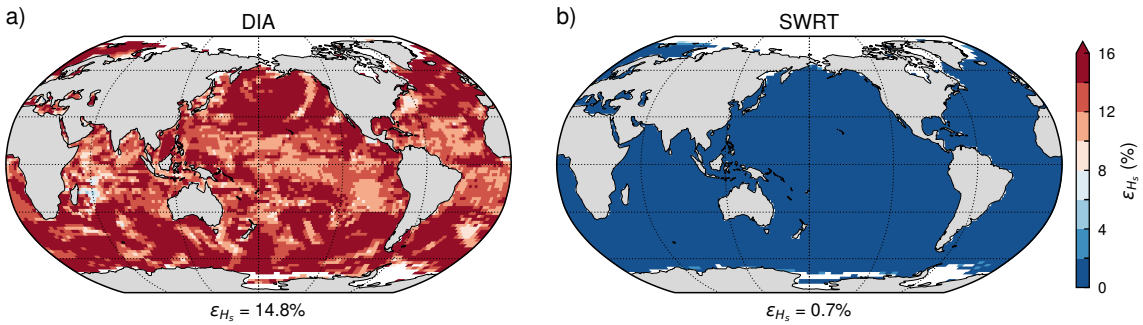



**Fig. 3.** $\varepsilon_{Hs}$ at each sea point over the 24-h ecWAM test for (a) DIA and (b) SWRT with K = 31, with $\varepsilon_{Hs}$ over all points under each map. Seas without a value are white, mostly the ice-covered polar seas.

## 5.3 Cost

The cost is measured with DR_HOOK in the optimized build of the 24-h runs, on one of four MPI tasks, and is given relative to DIA. WRT runs through the same vectorized routine as SWRT, and the difference in cost therefore comes from the numbers of configurations and offsets alone.

| Method | $S_{nl}$ | Time step | Run |
|---|---|---|---|
| SWRT with K = 31 | 4.0 | 1.6 | 1.4 |
| WRT | 68 | 14 | 11 |

$S_{nl}$ takes about a fifth of a time step with DIA, half with SWRT and nearly all of it with WRT (Fig. 4).

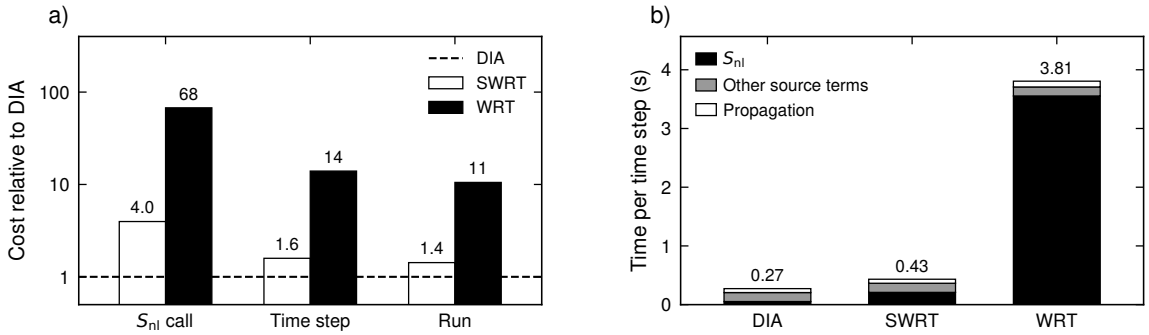



**Fig. 4.** Cost of $S_{nl}$ in the 24-h ecWAM test. (a) Cost of SWRT with K = 31 (white) and WRT (black) relative to DIA (dashed line) for one $S_{nl}$ call, one time step and the run; (b) time per time step, split into $S_{nl}$, the other source terms and propagation.